Rep. Tom Emmer on The Record with Greta Van Susteren

Radio

Broadcast: October 19, 2026 • Duration: 6:09

GRETA:

House Majority Whip and Republican Minnesota Congressman Tom Emmer joins me. Nice to talk to you, sir. And I don't know if you heard, but at the top of the show, we played President Macron of France, who is blaming all their unrest upon the war in Iran, which is code for President Trump. And I know that, I mean, I played a soundbite last week where Macron says that Iran can never have a nuclear weapon. But do you have any thoughts about Macron blaming the United States for their unrest in France?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, that's what a lot of people do, Greta, and good to be with you. A lot of people, especially failed leaders, what they do right away is blame someone other than themselves. Look, we've got the same example in this country that we better be watching what's going on in France. We want everyone to come to this country and chase their American dream. We want them to come here legally. And we also, Greta, want them to come to be Americans. We celebrate culture in this country like no one else. You're Irish. We celebrate your culture. You're German. We celebrate your culture. You're Somali. We celebrate your culture. If you assimilate and become an American, if you don't come to this country to be an American, what you're seeing in Paris is what is going to happen. You cannot have a different country within your country. Everybody is either an American or they should get out.

GRETA:

Well, obviously, the elections are upon us, and the Speaker of the House says he's not buying the polls, that Republicans don't trust polls. But let me just jump ahead to December 11th, whether, you know, whether Republicans keep the House or not, the government is going to need some money. We're going to run out of money. Is there something being done right now in anticipation for December 11th when we go through that nightmare about government funding?

REP. TOM EMMER:

Yeah, I mean, first, before you leave it, the polling, there were two polls that came out two weeks ago on the very same day in Iowa. One had Ashley Hinson up by five, the other one down by seven. Mike's right. Our speaker's right. Republicans don't trust these pollsters. They don't want to be tracked. They don't want to be in a database. So they typically are not responding to these things, and they're not reflective of what the ground really is. When it comes to December 11th, first off, I'm confident that Republicans will maintain our majorities in the U.S. House and the U.S. Senate, Greta. The House has already passed multiple appropriations bills. We've done our work. It's ready to go. And I fully expect that we're going to be able to get that done by the December 11th date.

GRETA:

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Well, I should hope so, because everybody's out trying to get our vote right now so they can go to Congress. And that's great. But, you know, but, you know, if the job is not being done and we go into that, you know, that nightmare on December 11th, that is rather disheartening, you know, when time now could actually be spent trying to figure that one out.

REP. TOM EMMER:

Well, Greta, I would push back just a little bit. The work has been done. The work has been done. Keep in mind the Democrats believe that they don't want to give any wins to Republicans and more importantly, to Donald Trump before the election. So it was just one of those unfortunate political circumstances where even though we've done the work, they were not going to participate. And obviously in the Senate, we need to have Democrats in order to satisfy that filibuster rule that they still have. I'm firmly bullish on once we get through the next 15 days, once we know that Republicans have held the House and the Senate, we're going to be very quick to get that work done.

GRETA:

You mentioned the Senate, your home state of Minnesota, there is a very hot race, Republican nominee Michelle Tafoya versus Lieutenant Governor Peggy Flanagan. And a major issue is fraud, and that same issue that seems to have convinced Governor Tim Walz back earlier in the year not to seek reelection. And these two Senate candidates have debated the issue. Let's listen. Under her watch, while she was second in command of this state, Minnesota saw billions and billions and billions of fraud dollars walk out the door to fraudsters while Medicaid was gutted, while feeding our future was gutted. Do you have any ownership over the fraud that occurred over the last two terms of this administration? The governor has been very clear that he, the buck stops with him. He was the one who had oversight here. I've led on issues like paid family and medical leave. Senator, you've got a strong Democratic candidate, looks like, and Senator Klobuchar, she's likely to win that race. And I don't know how she impacts this Senate race. But this is a pretty hot race between these two candidates for the Senate, these two women.

REP. TOM EMMER:

I think Michelle Tafoya is the preferred candidate. You just heard Peggy Flanagan try to blame Tim Walz when she was standing right at his side. Look, it's all about fraud and corruption. Senator Klobuchar has a good brand in Minnesota. But how is she going to clean this up? I think Lisa DeMuth is in that race as well. But on this one, the fraud and corruption is real. The feeding our future scandal, the Medicaid fraud that she's talking about, Peggy Flanagan has been there for all of it. And on this one, I think Minnesotans are sick and tired of seeing this happen. And do you realize that under Peggy Flanagan's watch, not one government official, not one member of the Walz-Flanagan administration has been called out, has been indicted, has been reprimanded in their job or fired as a result of the $250 million feeding our future scandal? That's outrageous. And that's not leadership. That frankly is being part of the fraud. The other one is our attorney general, Keith Ellison. He's up to his eyeballs in it, Greta. They should all be run out on a rail.

GRETA:

Well, I guess I was suggesting that this clobber chair, she'd bring out the Democratic vote and that would create the problem, you know, for the other members, the Republicans, I take it. But we'll see what happens. That Senate race is a fascinating one to watch. Anyway, good luck in your own campaign, sir. Thank you very much for joining me. House Majority Whip Congressman Tom Emmer.

REP. TOM EMMER:

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Thank you, Greta.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.
Source: Radio (October 19, 2026)
Archived: October 19, 2026
Source URL: https://youtu.be/GR0NkQSYdBg
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